Vinny Leonard's papers, compared with what Velocity does at UHL

Sources read in full on 8 Nov: Vinny's four documents (LSOS brochure draft V5, 29 Oct; PTMA talk deck, 29 Oct; "ChatGPT on SPA AI opportunity", 3 Nov; LSOS Agentic AI Reference Architecture, 3 Nov) and Shane's UHL paper "AI at UHL: the year ahead" (4 Nov, to Paul Candon). UHL facts beyond that paper come from Cuan's own records. [V] = in a document; [R] = from Cuan records, not re-checked today.

1. The short answer

Vinny has a good sales-management method and a careful design on paper. Velocity has a live, paying client and working systems. They fit together: Vinny's method as the front door, the UHL model as what gets delivered. Vinny has no named client, no build, no price and no hosting for his six-agent design. Nothing in his papers conflicts with what you and Shane do. The gap to close is proof and ownership, not ideas.

2. What Vinny has put in front of you

- **LSOS (Lean Sales Operating System).** [V] Five disciplines: Direction, Execution, Visibility, Improvement, Governance. Journey: Assess, Discuss, Kickstart (seven delivery days), Blueprint (0-30, 31-60, 61-90, 90+ day roadmap), Implement, Improve. Nine "management artefacts" such as sales strategy on a page, pipeline and forecast review, executive dashboard. Motto: "process first, technology second". Kickstart has "no upfront commitment to the full implementation programme". No prices appear.
- **PTMA talk (29 Oct, 17 to 18 minutes, manufacturers).** [V] Lean thinking applied to sales; a "7 day Lean Sales Start". His profile: 25 years in financial services sales, 12 years as Director of Sales and Marketing at LBSPartners, Lean Black Belt (UL), Master of Business (UCC/IMI). Says financial support "may be available" through Enterprise Ireland and IDA Ireland subject to eligibility (not checked).
- **ChatGPT research on the AI opportunity (3 Nov).** [V] Eight published sources (McKinsey, Harvard Business Review, an academic paper) cited as showing sales underperformance is mostly a management and process problem, and that agentic AI can help if the process is defined first. It warns not to promise revenue growth. Cuan has not verified the cited findings or dates; treat as ChatGPT's summary.
- **LSOS Agentic AI Reference Architecture, V1 (3 Nov).** [V] One orchestrator plus six agent roles (prospecting, qualification, pipeline, sales execution, forecasting, coaching). CRM is the record for customers, ERP for orders and money. Five autonomy levels; V1 stays at "recommend" and "prepare". Explicit V1 bans: no autonomous negotiation, discounting, contracts, forecast commitments, order release or people decisions. Phased roadmap from 1-3 weeks of discovery to a 4-8 week pilot. Says plainly it is vendor-neutral design guidance and makes no claims about vendor capability or results.

3. What Velocity does with UHL

- **Training by role.** [R] Since the summer: sessions for the senior leadership team and the commercial team (three commercial sessions, the last on 15 Oct), built around each person's own work, with a personal readiness profile and tools for each. Commercial team materials give a four-step process: find useful skills, build a skill, inspect it, review UHL-specific governance exposures.
- **Personal orchestrations.** [V] This week (per Shane's paper) Paul Candon's and Dave's go in on their own accounts, "read and draft only", with work checked on a second model before it reaches them. Each could use about three over time.
- **The retainer proposal.** [V] Shane's "AI at UHL: the year ahead" (4 Nov, for the 5 Nov meeting): three areas (AI capability and learning; defensibility, systems and resilience; cybersecurity), a "5:01" question, and a monthly retainer in five parts (a day on site a month, core systems, staying ahead of the models, continuous learning, embedding AI with governance). It states no fee. Its four cyber examples are cited from outside sources that Cuan has not verified.
- **Public endorsement.** [V] Paul Candon commented publicly on Shane's article (leadership first, skills and confidence, accountability, data protection and cybersecurity, practical experimentation, measure the benefits). That is not consent to name UHL elsewhere.

4. Side by side

Point	Vinny / SPA (on paper)	Velocity at UHL (live)
Focus	The sales function of one business: process, management routines, then AI inside it.	Whole leadership and commercial teams: skills first, then personal systems, then governance and security.
Starting point	Diagnose the sales process (Kickstart, seven days), then a roadmap.	Train people on their own work, then build tools they actually use.
Where AI sits	Six bounded agents in a sales workflow, CRM and ERP integrated, human approvals.	Role-based skills and personal orchestrations; read and draft only; second-model check.
Controls	Detailed on paper: least privilege, autonomy levels, audit trail, kill switch, explicit V1 bans.	Read and draft only, checked on a second model, role-by-role; governance and security in the proposed retainer. Less written down.
Evidence	Cited articles and Vinny's sales career. No client results, no pilot data in these papers.	Live use with a paying client since summer; invoices paid for sessions.
Commercial model	Kickstart then blueprint then implementation projects. No prices stated.	Training invoiced by session; monthly retainer proposed; no fee stated in the paper.
Who builds and runs it	Not stated. SPA owns method; client owns data and systems; technology is "vendor-neutral".	Velocity builds, trains and runs; Shane is the technical engine.

Honesty on claims	Careful: no guaranteed revenue growth.	Careful in the paper; cyber examples need checking.
Main risk	Paper without a pilot; unclear delivery and ownership.	One client; depends on Shane; your own interest at UHL (below).

5. How they could fit

- Vinny diagnoses a client's sales process and runs the management rhythm (his strength, and his relationship). Velocity trains the team, builds the orchestrations and runs the governance (the UHL model). Start with **one pilot client**, small, on a monthly retainer.
- His six-agent design is a good brief for what Velocity could build, because the control model matches how you work. It needs a real client's sales process and CRM before it is more than a paper.

6. Before any reply goes further

- **Shane first.** No commercial or technical commitment without Shane's alignment (your standing rule). Your holding note to Vinny (in Gmail drafts) promises a view by the end of next week.
- **Do not name UHL or Paul Candon** to Vinny's clients without Paul's consent, even though Paul commented publicly.
- **Your interest at UHL.** A Velocity retainer to UHL while you sit on UHL's board and Audit Committee needs your interest declared and handled; this also affects how UHL is used as a reference.
- **Who contracts.** Meridian is not incorporated, so nothing goes through it. Decide with Shane which entity (for example Velocity) contracts, and how any build is owned, given the Noesis IP structure.
- **Questions for Vinny:** who is the pilot client and what is their sales process; his commercial terms (who owns the client relationship, any share); who owns a build made for his client; how data protection roles would work; whether the Enterprise Ireland and IDA support he mentions applies.

Cuan view, a judgement, not a sourced finding. Cited articles inside Vinny's ChatGPT paper have not been verified.